

SF Equity Vendor Matrix

Pitch Plan & Institutional Strategy

Prepared 2026-05-17 · Nischal Divecha & Mithran Sadasivam · github.com/ndivecha03/SF_Vendor_Matrix

READ FIRST: The SF pitch is NOT "NYC but for sidewalks." Do not lead with NYC. Lead with the Nuru scandal, the Controller's 2024 PIR, and Mayor Lurie's small-business agenda. Those three facts mean the city is already looking for this tool. Your job is to show up as the answer.

TL;DR — Four Things to Hold in Your Head

1. Policy lever: SF Chapter 14B is NOT PPB Rule 3-08. It operates via a Micro-LBE construction set-aside ($\leq \$600K$) and a 10% LBE bid discount. No direct-purchase analog at \$1.5M scale. The matrix changes accordingly.
2. v1 target is sidewalk repair (SIRP), not streetlights. SFPUC and PG&E maintain all SF streetlights in-house. There is no contractor pool. Do not mention streetlights as a v1 use case in any SF meeting.
3. The LBE directory is the critical data gap. SF does not publish LBE certification as a Socrata dataset. You must scrape sfcitypartner.sfgov.org or get a CSV from CMD Director Regina Chan before you can run the join.
4. The political tailwind is exceptional and time-limited. The Nuru scandal, the Controller's 2024 PIR flagging \$151M of pre-qualified pools as fraud-risk, and Lurie's First Year Free small-business program (extended through June 2026) are all live right now. The window is open; don't waste it.

1. The 60-Second Pitch Arc

Memorize this sequence. Every conversation with an SF official should hit these four beats in order, regardless of who you're talking to:

Beat 1 — The problem (15 seconds)

"SF spends roughly \$35M/year on sidewalk repair, concentrated among five prime contractors. The Controller's 2024 Public Integrity Review flagged this kind of pre-qualified pool as a top fraud-risk area."

Beat 2 — The lever (15 seconds)

"SF Chapter 14B, as amended January 2025, gives the city two clean policy levers already on the books: a Micro-LBE construction set-aside for contracts at or below \$600K, and a 10% LBE bid discount. SIRP work-order packages average \$50K–\$500K. They fit cleanly inside that ceiling."

Beat 3 — What we built (15 seconds)

"We built a vendor-selection matrix that surfaces ranked, equity-weighted C-8 concrete contractor recommendations in seconds, with transparent score breakdowns for audit defense. The tool operationalizes the set-aside — no new spending, no new mandates, no new legislation."

Beat 4 — The ask (15 seconds)

"We're asking for a 90-day pilot in one DPW district. ≥30 dispatches. ≥40% routed to Micro-LBE or LBE firms. ≥80% citizen satisfaction at 30 days. We can be ready to start within 30 days of a verbal commitment."

What you do NOT say in the first meeting:

- Do not compare to NYC unless directly asked. NYC is your proof-of-concept for yourselves; it is not a selling point to an SF official who may view NYC as irrelevant.
- Do not say "redistribution." Say "operationalizing a rule the city already enacted."
- Do not say "two firms dominate" without immediately pivoting to the policy lever. The concentration is context, not the story.
- Do not make the meeting about the software. Make it about the pilot commitment.

2. Stakeholder Map — Who, What, and in What Order

There are six categories of contacts. Prioritize them in the order shown. Contacts 1 and 2 unlock the pilot; 3 and 4 are operational dependencies; 5 is legal protection; 6 is political legitimacy.

Contact	Title	Why They Matter	The Ask
Carla Short	DPW Director	Operational pilot owner. SIRP lives here. Her sign-off is the pilot.	90-day one-district SIRP pilot commitment.
Greg Wagner	SF Controller	Wrote the 2024 PIR that flagged \$151M in pre-qual pools. Most aligned politically. May sponsor pilot independently.	Endorsement + Supplier Contracts data access.
Civic Bridge (MOCI)	16-wk pro-bono program	Canonical path for civic-tech tools. Gives department partner + timeline + legitimacy in one move.	Application slot in next 2026 cohort.
Regina Chan	CMD Director	Controls the LBE certified-firms list. Without her CSV, you are scraping. Her cooperation is the data gap fix.	Quarterly CSV export of certified LBE firms.
Stephanie Tang	Deputy City Admin	Oversees CMD post-2024 amendments.	Letter of support or intro to Chan + Short.

Contact	Title	Why They Matter	The Ask
		Endorsement is decisive for any 14B-touching initiative.	
David Chiu	City Attorney	Post-Coral Construction, SF 14B is race-neutral. Need written opinion on (a) displaying MBE/WBE alongside LBE, (b) synthetic effective-bid calculation liability.	Written legal opinion before public launch.

Approach sequence

Start with the Controller's Office (Wagner), not DPW. Reasons: (1) the 2024 PIR gives you a documented government mandate to cite, (2) the Controller is the political ally most aligned with your transparency framing, and (3) an endorsement from Wagner makes the DPW conversation dramatically easier. Do not cold-approach DPW without some upstream cover.

Civic Bridge timing

Civic Bridge runs 16-week cohorts. Applications typically open quarterly. If you are within 6 weeks of an application window, file immediately — this is the cleanest institutional path and gives you a DPW or CMD partner with political legitimacy baked in. If the next cohort is more than 3 months out, proceed with direct outreach and treat Civic Bridge as a v2 formalization.

3. What Actually Changes from the NYC Tool

3.1 Policy lever — the structural difference

NYC PPB Rule 3-08: any agency can buy directly from a certified M/WBE up to \$1.5M per purchase, no competitive solicitation required. Binary lever.

SF Chapter 14B: competitive procurements get a 10% bid discount for LBEs; construction work at or below \$600K can be set aside for Micro-LBEs; professional services get prime + sub goals. Layered lever, not binary.

Critical implication: the SF matrix cannot output a binary "direct-purchase eligible" flag. It must output (a) set-aside eligibility when the package is ≤\$600K and the vendor is Micro-LBE certified, and (b) a synthetic effective bid = nominal bid × 0.90 for LBE-eligible firms on competitive solicitations.

3.2 Scoring matrix changes

Direct comparison between NYC weights (scorer.js as shipped 2026-05-16) and SF target weights (docs/matrix-weights.md):

Component	NYC pts	SF pts	What Changed
Workload balance	22	20	Slightly lower; smaller city, fewer competing tickets per firm.
Overlooked-but-qualified	18	16	Smaller vendor universe reduces hidden inventory signal strength.
Direct-purchase eligibility (PPB 3-08)	15	0	REMOVED — no SF analog at this threshold.
Set-aside / bid-discount eligibility (14B)	—	18	NEW — full pts if Micro-LBE + work ≤\$600K; half if LBE/SBA-LBE with bid discount only.
Demographic equity	15	15	Unchanged. Pull from CalCERT MBE/WBE + SBA 8(a) cross-walked to LBE. Race-neutral framing required.
Proximity	13	10	Reframed: supervisor-district-match, not haversine miles. SF is 47 sq mi.
HQ-in-SF / local	—	8	NEW — 14B's LBE definition requires SF HQ. Partial credit for PUC-LBE.
Reliability	10	8	Pull from Supplier Contracts pmt_amt / agreed_amt ratio.
Baseline capability	4	3	Lower bar; smaller pool.
Capacity headroom	3	2	Same logic, smaller scale.

Highlighted rows: gold = new SF component, red = removed from SF version. Total: 100 points.

3.3 Race-neutrality constraint (do not skip this)

After Coral Construction v. City of San Francisco (2010), SF 14B is explicitly race-neutral. The program targets size and locality, not minority status. Displaying MBE/WBE status alongside LBE certification in your matrix output is legally uncertain until David Chiu's office provides written guidance. Until that opinion is in docs/, keep demographic badges dispatcher-only, not public-facing.

3.4 Proximity logic change

NYC: haversine distance with 10-mile radius.

SF: supervisor-district-match scoring. Full points if vendor and complaint share the same supervisor district (11 districts across 47 sq mi). Half points if adjacent. Zero if not. This is more politically legible than miles in a city this small, and aligns with how DPW actually thinks about coverage areas.

4. Data Gaps and How to Close Them

4.1 The LBE directory (critical path)

SF does NOT publish the LBE certified-firms list as a Socrata dataset. This is the single most important data gap. Without it, you cannot run the demographic-equity or set-aside eligibility joins. Resolve this before writing any scoring code.

Three options, in order of preference:

- Option A (preferred): Request a CSV export from CMD Director Regina Chan. Email or phone the CMD office directly. Frame as supporting 14B operationalization. Quarterly refresh agreement is the goal.
- Option B (unblock development): Scrape sfcitypartner.sfgov.org/pages/LBESearch programmatically. Approximately 1,400 firms. Technically simple — one afternoon. Politically risky if done without CMD awareness; disclose it once you have a pilot partner.
- Option C (hybrid): Scrape for v0 to unblock development now. Formalize a CSV export with CMD once you have a pilot commitment. This is the recommended approach.

WARNING: A dataset ID “y8fp-fbf5” appears in some third-party blog posts as the LBE directory. It actually returns 2014 SFO Customer Survey data. Verify every DataSF dataset ID against the live catalog page before integrating.

4.2 Remaining data sources (verified live)

Purpose	Dataset ID	Status	NYC Analog
Contract awards	cqi5-hm2d	Verified live	qyyg-4tf5
Sub-threshold payments	p5r5-fd7g	Verified live	mxwn-eh3b (Checkbook NYC)
311 service requests	vw6y-z8j6	Verified live (6M+ rows)	erm2-nwe9
Registered businesses	g8m3-pdis	Verified live (~300K rows)	DOB License Info t8hj-ruu2
C-8 contractor licenses	CSLB bulk export by county	Verified — state-level, not Socrata	DOB Master Electrician roster
LBE directory	NOT on Socrata	CRITICAL GAP — scrape or request CSV	ci93-uc8s (SBS M/WBE Dir.)

5. Impact Estimate — The Numbers to Cite

Be precise and conservative. These numbers are defensible; do not round up.

5.1 Sidewalk repair v1 (SIRP)

Annual SIRP work volume (estimated)	~\$35M/yr
Incumbent share (top 3–5 prime C-8 contractors)	~70%
Redirectable to LBE via set-aside + bid discount	~25%

Annual redirected dollars	$\$35\text{M} \times 70\% \times 25\% = \6.1M
LBE C-8 firms in the vendor pool	80–150 firms
Average per-firm annual uplift	\$40K–\$75K/yr

5.2 v2 stretch (tree maintenance)

StreetTreeSF M03 master contract. ~\$5M/yr redirectable across ~30 D-49 arborist firms. The 14B goal is currently waived on most tree contracts — that waiver is itself the redistribution opportunity. Total v1+v2: ~\$11M/yr across ~120–180 firms.

Do NOT present the stretch case in the first meeting. Lead with \$6.1M and 90-day pilot. The stretch case is for a second meeting or a written follow-up after interest is confirmed.

6. Phased Next Steps

Phase 0 — Unblock (this week, before any outreach)

You cannot walk into any data conversation without having run the LBE scrape first. Do this before you contact anyone. It takes one afternoon and gives you a real vendor count to cite.

Phase / Task	Description	Owner	Done When
Scrape LBE directory	Pull sfcitypartner.sfgov.org LBE Search into a CSV. Filter to C-8 concrete + adjacent NAICS. Get a real firm count.	Mithran	CSV in data/raw/sf_lbe_firms.csv with firm count
Download CSLB C-8 export	Pull CA Contractors State License Board bulk export, filter to SF county + C-8 classification.	Mithran	CSV in data/raw/sf_cslb_c8.csv
Baseline join	Run a preliminary name-normalized join: CSLB C-8 $\cap$ LBE directory. Get a real eligible vendor count.	Mithran	Printed count to cite in meetings
Verify DataSF IDs	Confirm cqj5-hm2d, p5r5-fd7g, vw6y-z8j6, g8m3-pdis all return live data. Do not trust third-party references.	Nischal	4 URLs confirmed in a doc
Map network contacts	Who is on first-name basis with anyone at DPW, CMD, Controller's, or MOCI? List every contact before deciding who to approach first.	Nischal	Contact map doc with ranked warm intros

Phase 1 — First Contact (weeks 1–2)

Phase / Task	Description	Owner	Done When
Controller's Office outreach	Email Greg Wagner's office citing the 2024 PIR directly. Frame the tool as the transparency layer the PIR recommended. Request 30-min intro call.	Nischal	Meeting booked
Civic Bridge application	Check the 2026 application window at sf.gov/civic-bridge . If open, file immediately. The application is the cleanest institutional path.	Nischal	Application submitted or window date known
CMD / Regina Chan contact	Email CMD to request a quarterly LBE CSV export. Frame as supporting 14B operationalization. This is independent of whether you scrape first.	Nischal	Response received (yes/no/redirect)
One-page pitch memo	Compress the 60-second arc (Section 1) into a one-page PDF. Attach to every outreach email. No more than 400 words, one table of impact numbers, one ask sentence.	Both	PDF in docs/sf-pitch-one-pager.pdf
SF v0 branch	Stand up github.com/ndivecha03/SF_Vendor_Matrix with build-vendors-sf.py stub. Even an empty scaffold signals this is real.	Mithran	Repo exists with README and empty scripts/

Phase 2 — Pre-Pilot Build (weeks 3–6, after first contact)

Phase / Task	Description	Owner	Done When
Matrix weight swap	Replace NYC scorer.js weights with SF weights from docs/matrix-weights.md. Remove direct-purchase component. Add set-aside eligibility + HQ-in-SF components.	Mithran	scorer-sf.js passes test-scorer-sf.mjs on 5 SF district complaints
14B eligibility logic	Add function: isSetAsideEligible(vendor, workOrderAmt) → bool. Add effectiveBid(vendor, nominalBid) → number applying 10% LBE discount.	Mithran	Unit tests pass; output matches hand-calculated examples
Supervisor-district proximity	Replace haversine with supervisor-district lookup. Use SF district boundary GeoJSON from DataSF.	Mithran	rankTop() uses district scoring; no haversine import
Supplier Contracts join	Pull cqi5-hm2d, filter to DPW + keywords (SIDEWALK, CONCRETE, CURB, PAVEMENT, SIRP). Identify incumbent primes.	Mithran	Incumbents list in data/sf_incumbents.csv
Vendor portal race-neutral draft	Draft vendor-facing badge copy that does not display MBE/WBE publicly. Dispatcher-only until legal opinion received.	Nischal	PR reviewed; no public race-specific badges
Legal review request	Via pilot partner or independent counsel: written opinion on (a) displaying CalCERT MBE/WBE alongside LBE, (b) synthetic effective-bid liability.	Nischal	Written opinion in docs/sf-legal-opinion.pdf

Phase 3 — Pilot (90 days, target start Q3 2026)

Phase / Task	Description	Owner	Done When
Pilot agreement	One-page memo: one DPW district, one complaint type (SIRP), 90 days, 3 success metrics. Get informal sign-off before writing code for pilot.	Nischal	Signed memo in docs/sf-pilot-agreement.pdf
Agency auth	SF.gov SSO or simpler magic-link for DPW dispatcher login. Role: dispatcher sees demographic badges; public view does not.	Mithran	Dispatcher can log in; public view is clean
Dispatch audit log	Every dispatch writes to Supabase: vendor_id, district, score snapshot, dispatcher_id, timestamp. Required for 14B reporting.	Mithran	Audit log populated after first test dispatch
Outcome loop	Post-dispatch SMS to citizen at +30 days. Vendor completion attestation in portal. Feeds reliability component.	Both	≥10 dispatches with outcome data
Mid-pilot memo (week 6)	Two pages: dispatches to date, % to Micro-LBE/LBE, quality delta vs. incumbent baseline, one chart. Share with DPW partner.	Both	Memo delivered to partner by week 7

7. Kill Criteria — When to Stop

Set calendar reminders for each date. Decide in advance what “kill” means: shut down, hand off to Code for America or SPUR, write-up as a policy paper, or pivot to v2 trade (tree maintenance).

- No pilot partner committed by 2026-08-01: pivot to research-paper mode. NYC pilot becomes the prior art. SF becomes a documented policy proposal.
- Legal review surfaces a blocker on displaying demographic data publicly: pivot to dispatcher-only mode. Do not fight the legal opinion; work within it.
- Civic Bridge application rejected and no direct DPW contact by 2026-07-01: escalate via Controller’s Office as the alternate sponsor path.
- Pilot launches but fewer than 10 dispatches happen in 60 days: tool is not being used. Stop adding features; diagnose why.
- LBE directory scrape produces fewer than 50 SF C-8 firms after deduplication: vendor pool is too thin to demo credibly. Contact CMD immediately; do not proceed with a public pitch on thin data.

8. Talking Points by Audience

For the Controller’s Office (Wagner)

- "Your 2024 PIR recommended a transparency layer for pre-qualified contractor pools. This tool is that layer."

- "We don't need new data. We pull from Supplier Contracts (cqj5-hm2d) and the 14B LBE directory. Everything is already public — we just connect it."
- "The audit log we generate feeds directly into the city's annual M/WBE utilization reporting."

For DPW / Carla Short

- "Your dispatchers face a choice every time a SIRP complaint comes in: call the prime you always call, or find an alternative manually. We compress that manual step to seconds."
- "Every dispatch produces an auto-generated 14B justification memo with the vendor's certification ID, NAICS code, and score breakdown. If an incumbent asks why they weren't chosen, you have a documented, replayable answer."
- "The pilot is one district, one complaint type, 90 days. Success criteria are yours to define."

For CMD (Regina Chan)

- "We need a quarterly CSV export of the certified LBE firms list to run the eligibility join. Without it, we're building the tool without knowing who's certified."
- "The tool surfaces 14B eligibility to dispatchers in real time. It operationalizes the set-aside your office administers."
- "A pilot would give CMD a live data point on how many set-aside-eligible firms actually receive dispatches vs. how many are in the pool but never contacted."

For Civic Bridge / MOCI

- "This fits the Civic Bridge model exactly: a civic-tech tool with a defined city-department partner (DPW), a 16-week engagement arc, and measurable equity outputs."
- "We already have a working NYC version. The SF port is mostly matrix weight changes and a new data join. The engagement time is spent on institutional integration, not from-scratch builds."

9. One-Page Pitch Memo — Outline

Draft this in docs/sf-pitch-one-pager.pdf before any outreach. Four sections, hard 400-word limit, one impact table, one sentence ask at the bottom.

- Header: SF Equity Vendor Matrix · DPW Sidewalk Repair Pilot Proposal · [date]
- Problem (50 words): SF spends ~\$35M/yr on SIRP concentrated among 5 prime contractors. Controller's 2024 PIR flagged this pool as fraud-risk. The 14B Micro-LBE set-aside (\$600K ceiling) exists to fix it but is operationally unused for SIRP work.
- What we built (75 words): Vendor-selection matrix that surfaces Micro-LBE and LBE certified C-8 concrete contractors ranked by equity-weighted score. Matrix components: LBE set-aside eligibility, 10% bid-discount modeling, SF HQ/local flag, supervisor-district proximity, demographic equity (dispatcher-only), workload balance, reliability, overlooked-but-qualified. Transparent score breakdown for every recommendation. Auto-generated 14B justification memo per dispatch.
- Impact table: \$6.1M/yr redirectable | 80–150 eligible LBE C-8 firms | \$40K–\$75K avg per-firm uplift | 0 new spending required | 0 new mandates required

- Ask (25 words): 90-day pilot in one DPW district. ≥ 30 dispatches, $\geq 40\%$ to Micro-LBE/LBE, $\geq 80\%$ citizen satisfaction at 30 days. Ready to start within 30 days of a verbal commitment.